



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	31 st May 2023	Time of Incident:	16:36
Region / Directorate:	RMO/ Wheatbelt	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Injury/ Illness	EQSafe Incident Number:	31678
Actual Consequence:	Moderate	Potential Consequence:	Moderate

Incident Short Description:	Operator lacerates leg when exiting grader, resulting in LTI
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Executive Summary:
On Wednesday 31st May at approximately 5.00pm, an operator (IP) had been tasked to move a Grader to an alternative location so that it was secured prior to leaving site. There was significant rainfall at the time of the incident, and the Grader was surrounded by wet, muddy ground conditions. Prior to climbing up into the Grader, the IP has noted the wet components of the grader and their wet hands and boots. The IP has placed their right foot onto the second step of the grader to maintain three points of contact to avoid slipping. As the IP pulled themselves up, putting weight onto their right foot, their foot has slipped off the damaged step and the IP has fallen backwards, striking their right calf on the grader blade. IP has then felt strong pain and confirmed that the right calf below the muscle was bleeding. The IP was taken to seek medical attention and has received 20 stitches as treatment. IP has been declared unfit for full duties (LTI) for 7 days.

Incident Photos:



The Grader



Damaged steps which the operator was attempting to scale

Contributing Factors:	
• No prestart book available in plant for the operator to report defects. • Operator assumed it was safer to access the ladder from the grader blade rather than the ground due to muddy conditions from recent heavy rain events. • Not taking the condition of steps and weather into consideration when climbing hastily into grader. • Rain had made handrails and steps wet and slippery. • Damage to steps on both sides of grader. • No maintenance records were available for the grader. • No site inspections completed to ensure plant prestarts were being conducted.	
Corrective Actions:	
• Steps on the grader were replaced. • Risk assessments were conducted on all contractor owned plant. • Incident communicated across contractors organisation. • Plant prestart books were sourced.	
Additional Issues/Learnings:	
• Ensure all, not just mechanical, components of plant, vehicles and equipment, components, are in functional order.	
Distribution of Notice:	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations